SALES & DISTRIBUTION STRATEGY

Rewiring Marico's Route to Market for the Omnichannel Era

A diagnostic on channel architecture, salesforce sizing, CRM technology and circular distribution — built for a live industry audience.

Sales & Distribution Management | Team Capstone Project (A01 / AS4)

Arush Pratap Singh
Aman Kumar Singh
Ankit Kumar
Himanshu

THE CHALLENGE

Scale isn't the problem. Structure is.

Marico already reaches deep into India. The strategic question is how three transitions — direct coverage, omnichannel demand, and data-driven field ops — get reconciled at once.

5.8M+

Retail outlets reached across India

7,500+

Stockists forming the distribution backbone

60,000+

Villages penetrated by the network

1M → 1.5M

Direct-reach stores under Project SETU by FY27

A tiered distribution intensity by brand — not one blanket rule

INTENSIVE	**Parachute · Saffola**	Near-ubiquitous kirana availability drives volume in low-involvement, repeat-purchase categories.
SELECTIVE	**Set Wet · Livon · Beardo**	Curated modern-trade & quick-commerce listings protect brand equity while capturing convenience demand.
EXCLUSIVE (EARLY)	**Plix & new D2C lines**	Owned D2C and premium e-commerce shield positioning before a wider general-trade rollout.

Conflict resolution: GT vs. quick-commerce price friction is resolved via Collaborating (channel-specific SKUs/pack sizes); distributor disintermediation under Project SETU is resolved via Compromising + Accommodating (first right to become logistics partners).

Sizing the field force with the Workload Method

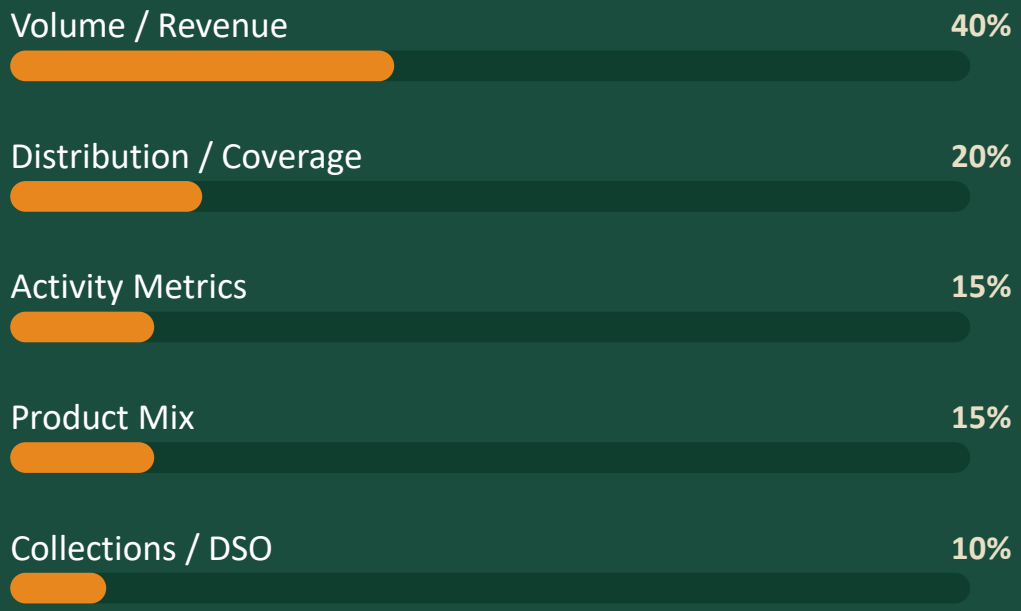
MODELLED RESULT (sample 40,000-outlet cluster)

≈ 459 reps

1,028,000 calls/year required ÷ 2,240 calls/rep/year capacity

Class A · weekly	6,000 outlets × 52 calls
Class B · fortnightly	22,000 outlets × 26 calls
Class C · monthly	12,000 outlets × 12 calls

BALANCED QUOTA MIX



A seven-stage distributor pipeline, closed by real-time POS data



Lead scoring

Prioritise Project SETU rollout outlets by proximity, category-switchability and payment-risk signals.

Real-time POS loop

Field DMS data syncs nightly; dashboards trigger stock-out alerts and draft replenishment orders.

Early-warning dashboard

Flags SKU-level price variance between general trade and quick-commerce automatically.

MODULE 4 — CIRCULAR LOGISTICS

Closing the loop through the network Marico already has

01

Collect

Distributors & retailers become informal collection points for empty rigid-plastic packs.

02

Incentivise

Trade-in credit per kg returned, part-funded by existing EPR obligations.

03

Reprocess

Material routed through Marico's recycler partners toward r-PCR packaging content.

04

Report

Kilograms collected tracked against EPR targets in the annual sustainability report.

ALIGNED TO THE UN SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 12 Responsible Consumption & Production — packaging circularity

SDG 13 Climate Action — reduced virgin plastic use & logistics emissions

SDG 17 Partnerships — India Plastics Pact collaboration model

Let's put this to the test.

We built this as a strategic diagnostic, not a finished blueprint - and we'd genuinely value perspective from anyone working in FMCG sales, distribution or channel strategy.

What would you challenge in our channel architecture, sizing model, or circular-logistics pilot? Drop a comment below — we're reading every one.

#SalesAndDistribution #FMCG #ChannelStrategy #Marico #CircularEconomy

Frameworks applied: Stern's Channel Structure Matrix · Thomas-Kilmann Conflict Modes · Workload Method salesforce sizing